

version brings higher system requirements much like Windows was until Windows 7.

PCs reached the stage where the average hardware specifications stabilised a bit since we began to see a diversity in devices that ranged from tiny netbooks with meagre specs to ultra-powerful multi-core desktop machines. It forced Windows to finally step back and ensure that the OS ran acceptably on the widest range of specifications possible.

Now the base system requirements of Windows haven't changed since Windows 7 which released in 2009. Remember, back then Android was just at v 1.5 and iOS was called iPhone OS and was at v 3.0; how much both have changed since then. The iPhone 3GS that launched around that time had a single-core 600MHz processor with around 256MB of RAM. Today even some entry-level phones are touting octa-core processors with at least 1GB of RAM.

The hardware release cycle is no longer what Microsoft has to keep up with, and a release every three years doesn't give Microsoft the opportunity to respond to trends as quickly as they need to be competitive today. Given Microsoft's model of charging for each new version of Windows, they also couldn't just switch to a yearly major release for Windows without causing a revolt.

So they did what Apple did quite a while ago, they made OS upgrades free. Like Apple, Microsoft recovers some money for the OS license each time a machine is sold with Windows installed on it. In addition they also sell their OS for people to use on their existing hardware, who in turn get a life time of Windows upgrades in return.

Many of us have been running Windows 10 preview builds since they were released in October and have seen how the UI, the feature-set, the performance, and the stability of Windows has changed over the just a few months between the first preview and release. If Microsoft can keep up this pace even after release then Windows might look and feel a lot different in just a few years.

Unfair Indian Pricing

Speaking of charging money, Microsoft really has done an injustice to the Indian audience there. Given how price sensitive the Indian market is, they should ideally have priced Windows lower in India than in other countries.

Rather what you will notice is that the Indian pricing is higher than the American pricing. Where the Home edition costs \$119 in the USA (₹ 7,700